

SAMPLE EDITION · SEPTEMBER 2026

UK Healthcare Market Report 2026

NHS, NICE, MHRA and four-nation access intelligence — pharmaceuticals, medical devices, VPAG pricing and ICB formulary variation across England, Scotland, Wales and Northern Ireland.

COVERAGE

United Kingdom

FOCUS

NHS · NICE · MHRA

USE

UK-wide launch

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This PDF is a **gated sample** aligned to **bionixus.com/uk-healthcare-market-report** (published / modified 27 May 2026) and the UK market-intelligence KPIs on that page. Not an NHSBSA extract. Not legal, medical or investment advice.

WHAT THIS SAMPLE IS — AND IS NOT

It is a board briefing from BioNixus published intelligence. A NICE recommendation for England is not automatic UK-wide access — Scotland (SMC), Wales (AWMSG) and Northern Ireland run distinct processes. Headline chips follow the live hero; KPI and FAQ bands are printed where they differ.

Live page: [bionixus.com/uk-healthcare-market-report](#) · Related: [/germany-healthcare-market-report](#) · [/healthcare-market-research](#) · [/gcc-pharma-market-report-2026](#)

02 United Kingdom at a glance

68.5M POPULATION 2026 (ONS)	~£260B HEALTHCARE MARKET 2026	~£21B PHARMA MARKET 2026	~£12B DEVICES MARKET 2026
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The UK is Europe’s second-largest pharmaceutical market and the world’s fifth-largest by value (executive summary). NHS accounts for roughly **78%** of healthcare expenditure (FAQ). Four health systems — England, Scotland, Wales, Northern Ireland — do not share a single formulary.

PUBLISHED SERIES	HEALTHCARE	PHARMA	DEVICES
Page hero / FAQ (headline)	GBP 250–270B (~USD 315–340B) · ~£260B · 11.4% of GDP	GBP 20–22B (USD 25–28B) · ~£21B	GBP 12–13B (USD 15–16B) · ~£12B
On-page market-intelligence KPIs	NHS budget GBP 167B (2025/26, HM Treasury); THE GBP 280+B · 11.3% of GDP	GBP 21–24B (ABPI)	GBP 12–14B (ABHI)

CAPACITY

68.5 million (ONS). GDP per capita USD 46,000 (IMF 2025). 223 NHS Trusts. ~141,000 NHS beds (2.0 per 1,000) plus ~10,000 private. 8,000+ GP practices (~6,500 patients per practice). 42 ICBs in England.

INSTITUTIONS

MHRA (post-Brexit, independent of EMA). NICE (England). SMC (Scotland). AWMSG (Wales). NI Department of Health adopts NICE. NHS Supply Chain. VPAG 2024–2028 (page body; FAQ still names the predecessor VPAS on the pharma-size question).

Hero, FAQ and UK sections on /uk-healthcare-market-report. KPI panel: BioNexus UK market intelligence.

03 UK pharmaceutical market

FAQ size **GBP 20–22 billion** (hero ~£21B); KPI **GBP 21–24 billion (ABPI)**. NHS is the primary payer. A positive NICE Technology Appraisal **mandates NHS funding within 90 days** in England.

NICE ROUTES (LIVE PAGE)

STA for most single products. MTA when a class is compared. HST for ultra-rare disease (higher QALY threshold). Independent ERG critiques the submission. Manufacturers may appeal draft guidance. ICER typically **GBP 20,000–30,000/QALY**; end-of-life / severity modifier applies. Budget-impact test: projected cost above about **GBP 20 million** in any of the first three years can trigger extra NHS England commercial negotiation before the 90-day mandate.

MHRA AFTER BREXIT

National MA or reliance. IRP accepts FDA, EMA or TGA approvals — page access section: typical **60–150 days**. ILAP (MHRA + NICE + NHSE + SMC) aligns regulatory and HTA clocks for unmet need. KPI standard review: 210 days; 70-day abridged for generic/biosimilar.

FAQ THERAPY RANKING BY NHS SPEND

Oncology (largest; Cancer Drugs Fund) · cardiovascular (statins, anticoagulants, antihypertensives) · diabetes (GLP-1 growing rapidly) · immunology/biologics · respiratory (COPD/asthma biologics, ICS/LABA). Mental-health spend is growing with prescribing rates.

NICE, MHRA, ILAP/IRP and budget-impact facts: UK FAQ plus "Pharmaceutical Market Access Framework" and payer section.

04

Devices and NHS Supply Chain

~£12B HERO CHIP 2026	£12–13B FAQ (USD 15–16B)	£12–14B KPI (ABHI)
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UKCA marking is the Great Britain replacement for CE marking; the UK has repeatedly extended recognition of CE-marked devices. Northern Ireland continues to accept CE marking under the Windsor Framework — a dual-track requirement. **3,500+** medtech companies (FAQ).

NHS SUPPLY CHAIN

Central procurement organisation for framework agreements and category towers (consumables, devices, clinical products) used by NHS trusts in England. A framework award is necessary for routine trust purchasing but **does not guarantee uptake** — trusts and ICBs still choose what to stock. Categories named on the page: orthopaedics, cardiovascular devices, wound care, diagnostics.

Private groups — HCA, Spire, Nuffield Health, Ramsay — buy outside NHS Supply Chain (~10,000 private beds vs ~141,000 NHS).

Device sizes: hero / FAQ / ABHI KPI. Supply Chain and private groups: UK devices FAQ and regional-health section.

05

Therapy landscape

Therapy (KPI Panel)	2026 Size	Growth	What moves the market
Oncology	GBP 5.5–6.5B	9.5% CAGR	Cancer Drugs Fund; NCRAS audit; NHS Long Term Plan oncology investment
Cardiovascular	GBP 3.8–4.5B	6% CAGR	High-volume statins, ACE, NOACs; TAVI / structural heart
Immunology & biologics	GBP 3.2–3.8B	11% CAGR	NHS Biologics Programme; adalimumab biosimilars saved NHS GBP 360M/year
Respiratory	GBP 2.5–3.0B	7% CAGR	NICE-approved COPD/asthma biologics; GOLD-aligned prescribing
Diabetes	GBP 2.0–2.5B	12% CAGR	SGLT-2, GLP-1 (tirzepatide, semaglutide); NHS diabetes prevention programme

Condition	Published stat	Source on page
Cancer	~375,000 new diagnoses/year; breast, lung, colorectal, prostate	Cancer Research UK 2024
Cardiovascular disease	170,000 heart attacks/year; ~7.6 million living with CVD	BHF Heart Statistics 2024
Type 2 diabetes	4.4 million diagnosed with diabetes (90% T2DM)	Diabetes UK 2024

Therapy sizes and epidemiology: BioNexus UK market intelligence on the live report.

06

MHRA, NICE and VPAG

12–24 mo

REGULATORY APPROVAL

12–18 mo

PAYER LISTING POST-SUBMISSION

27–54 mo

LAUNCH TO ACCESS

Oncology CDF can shorten the total clock to about **24 months** (KPI). STA 12–18 months; MTA 18–24 months.

- 1 **MHRA MA** — national or IRP (FDA/EMA/TGA). Devices: UKCA / CE (extended recognition) + Windsor Framework in NI.
- 2 **NICE dossier** — can run in parallel post-MA or via managed access.
- 3 **Appraisal Committee** — 3–6 meetings over 12–18 months. ERG critique. Appeal window.
- 4 **NHS England commercial framework** — 3–6 months post-NICE. VPAG (2024–2028) repayments above the growth allowance; statutory scheme if a company does not join. FAQ pharma-size question still refers to the predecessor name VPAS.
- 5 **Cancer Drugs Fund** — conditional oncology access while evidence is collected; then NICE reassesses for routine commissioning.
- 6 **ICB formulary adoption** — 42 ICBs; 3–12 months. Postcode variation for speed and for products outside the statutory TA mandate.

KPI registration path + UK access / payer sections. CDF and VPAG: live page body (payer landscape).

07 Four nations and ICBs

NATION / BODY	PUBLISHED ACCESS FACT
England — 42 ICBs	Replaced CCGs (Health and Care Act 2022). Implement NICE TAs; retain discretion on local formulary speed and on products outside the statutory funding direction.
Scotland — SMC	Own HTA; typically advice within ~12–18 weeks of MA. PACE process for end-of-life and orphan medicines.
Wales — AWMSG	Appraises medicines NICE has not reviewed or that sit outside NICE remit. NICE TAs generally mandated for NHS Wales within a set window.
Northern Ireland	Department of Health typically endorses NICE TAs through its own adoption process — not a parallel appraisal body.
NHS England Specialised Commissioning	High-cost, low-volume (gene therapy, rare disease, complex devices) — national commercial negotiation alongside NICE.

Do not treat a single England NICE TA as a UK-wide listing date. Sequence SMC, AWMSG and NI adoption as separate workstreams.

NAMED UK COMPANIES (KPI)

AstraZeneca (Cambridge)	GSK (London)	Smith+Nephew	Hikma	Mundipharma	Pfizer	Novartis	Roche	MSD
Novo Nordisk								

Four-nation and ICB facts: UK FAQ plus “Regional Health System Structure”. Company chips: UK market intelligence.

08 NHS hospitals

Imperial College Healthcare NHS Trust — 1,100 beds; cardiac surgery, cancer, stroke.

King's College Hospital NHS Foundation Trust — 900 beds; liver transplant, cardiac, neurosciences.

University College London Hospitals — 665 beds; haematology, oncology, neurology.

Christie NHS Foundation Trust Manchester — 660 beds; largest cancer centre outside London; proton beam.

Great Ormond Street Hospital — 380 beds; paediatrics, rare disease, gene therapy, genomics.

Royal Marsden NHS Foundation Trust — 300 beds; UK's largest cancer centre; biomarker-led oncology trials.

223 NHS Trusts operate hospitals (NHS England, KPI). Private complement: HCA, Spire, Nuffield, Ramsay — ~10,000 beds.

Hospital list and beds: BioNexus UK market intelligence on [/uk-healthcare-market-report](#).

09 Methodology and sources

Figures are taken from **/uk-healthcare-market-report** (published / modified **27 May 2026**) and the UK market-intelligence KPI panel.
Sample edition: **September 2026**.

RECONCILIATION RULES

Headline chips: healthcare **~£260B**, pharma **~£21B**, devices **~£12B**. FAQ bands GBP 250–270B / 20–22B / 12–13B sit behind those chips. KPI THE “GBP 280+ billion” and NHS budget GBP 167 billion (2025/26) are a different published series (HM Treasury / THE), not averaged into the hero chip. Pharma KPI GBP 21–24B (ABPI) and devices GBP 12–14B (ABHI) are shown as the second series. VPAG (2024–2028) is the scheme named on the payer page; the pharma-size FAQ still says VPAS — both wordings are on the live page and are not silently rewritten.

CITED SECONDARY SOURCES (AS NAMED ON THE PAGE)

ONS — population. IMF 2025 — GDP per capita. HM Treasury — NHS budget. ABPI / ABHI — pharma / device KPIs. Cancer Research UK 2024, BHF 2024, Diabetes UK 2024 — epidemiology. NICE, MHRA, SMC, AWMMSG — page body.

Gated excerpt only. ICB formulary files, CDF data-collection protocols and hospital-level consumption remain in commissioned work.
Nothing herein is legal, medical, pricing or investment advice.

bionixus.com/uk-healthcare-market-report

NEXT STEP

Primary research, not a spreadsheet export.

BioNixus is a healthcare and pharmaceutical market research firm founded in 2012. Our London office is the commercial hub for UK and European companies that need GCC/MENA entry intelligence — and for global teams that need UK four-nation access mapped properly.

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admin@bionixus.com · +20 120 688 2323 (Cairo) · bionixus.com/contact